

## 07-16-2024 MCS Board Meeting

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gHqXeOJyQFk">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gHqXeOJyQFk</a> |
| Publication Date | 2024-07-17T10:06:49Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | mcs                                                                                                   |

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## Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie Community Schools Board of Education

### 1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

*Omitted (No statutory public hearing or committee session was held prior to calling the regular meeting to order).*

### 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order at [00:12:30](#), followed by a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Heeter, Ms. Barton Griffin, Dr. Washburn, Mr. Lammers.
  - **Absent:** Mr. Irvine (noted as being on vacation).
  - **Presiding Officer:** Board President Williams.

### 3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

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- **Ceremonial Openings:** Conducted a moment of silence and recited the Pledge of Allegiance [00:12:53](#).
  - **Approval of Minutes:** *Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text provided.*
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### 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

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- **00:21:43 Proposal to Increase the Elementary Instructional Day**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds (CEO) and Heidi (Staff).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Administration proposed lengthening the elementary academic day by 15 minutes to address a historically short instructional day compared to local and state averages (raising the total day and adding 45 hours/6.5 instructional days annually). Logistics include moving breakfast back into the cafeteria to ensure a strict 8:00 AM instructional start time and moving dismissal to 2:55 PM. The plan maintains 2-hour early release schedules and addresses after-school athletics/child care adjustments. Preschool schedules face certification/staffing ratio hurdles but will coordinate with sibling pickups.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:42:49](#).
- **00:44:15 Consent Agenda: New Hires & Personnel Recognitions**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board President Williams, Dr. Reynolds, and Dr. Bell.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The board welcomed new kindergarten teacher Amari Burks (Longfellow Elementary), highlighting Ball State University tuition discount partnerships for MCS employees. The board also recognized Joyce King, retiring after 25.5 years of service. Staff reported teacher staffing numbers: 44 resignations/retirements over the summer against 36 new hires, with 10-13 teacher openings remaining or being repurposed.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Amari Burks introduced herself and spoke briefly regarding her background.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:47:54](#).
- **00:48:01 Financial Report (June Results & Outlook)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Drum (Chief Financial Officer / Financial Staff).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the June financial results (six months into the calendar year). Total cash balance at the end of June was \$31.4 million, projected to remain over \$32 million by December. The state basic grant revenue is tracking at \$47.4 million. The common school loan balance is down to \$9 million (monthly payment increasing to \$180,000 through mid-2028). The operational fund faces ongoing pressure from tax caps and unexpected increases (such as a \$320,000 jump in Property and Casualty Insurance). Rainy day fund balance sits at \$6.2

million (projected over \$3 million by year-end). Plans for a future work session regarding state tax caps and operational sustainability were discussed.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:54:18](#) / [01:05:21](#).
- [00:53:27](#) **Teacher Appreciation Grant (TAG) Policy Approval**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tasha (Staff).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the annual Teacher Appreciation Grant policy for IDOE submission by September 17th. Funds will be distributed in December based on the prior year's evaluations, maintaining the mandatory 25% pay differential between highly effective and effective teachers.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:11:09](#).

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## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

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*No general open public comment period or citizen speakers from the floor were recorded in this transcript.*

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## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

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- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - [01:09:19](#) **I-READ 3 & Cell Phone Policy Updates:** Dr. Reynolds reported on upcoming data tracking for potential third-grade retentions under new state statutes. Additionally, the district's new student handbook aligns with Indiana code regarding cell phones: high school phones must be off and out of sight unless under teacher direction (with monitoring sheets implemented), and middle school phones must remain off and in lockers.
- **Adjournment:** Official adjournment disposition was approved by voice vote [01:11:26](#).

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